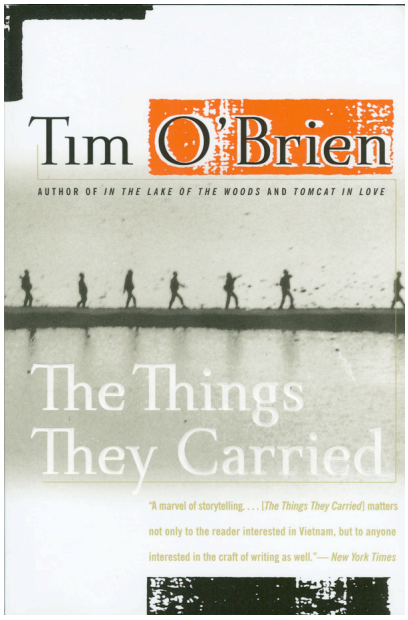
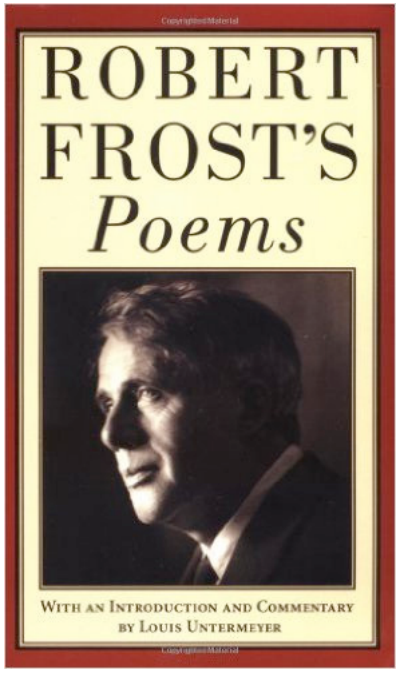
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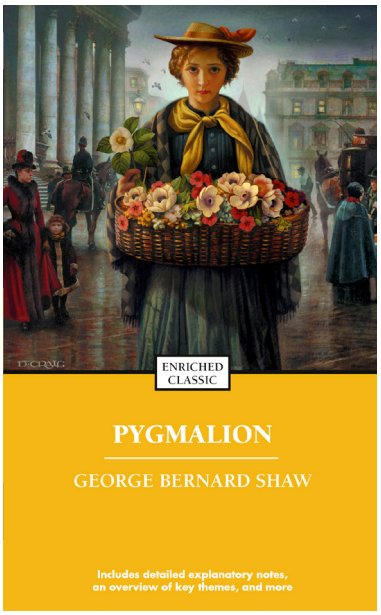
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Regional • 2016







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Region • 2016

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The simple element that serves as a basis for expanded narrative; or, less strictly, a conventional situation, device, interest, or incident, often recurring, especially in art and music, is

   A) emblem.
   B) image.
   C) motif.
   D) theme.
   E) thesis.

2. The term that is applied to the authorized or accepted list of books belonging, for example, in the Christian Bible, or accepted as attributable to a particular author, or as the body of recognized representative works of a particular group is

   A) canon.
   B) cento.
   C) chrestomathy.
   D) omnibus.
   E) pastiche.

3. A composition imitating another, usually serious, piece—one that is designed to ridicule a work or its style or author—is known as a

   A) burlesque.
   B) farce.
   C) hoax.
   D) parody.
   E) satire.

4. The eighteenth-century Colonial author of *Common Sense*, *The Rights of Man*, and *The Age of Reason*, is

   A) James Fenimore Cooper.
   B) Benjamin Franklin.
   C) Thomas Jefferson.
   D) James Madison.
   E) Thomas Paine.

5. The New England regional poet who received four (1924, 1931, 1937, and 1943) Pulitzer Prizes for Poetry is

   A) Conrad Aiken.
   B) Robert Frost.
   C) Robert Lowell.
   D) James Merrill.
   E) Theodore Roethke.

6. The idea that primitive human beings are naturally good and whatever evil they develop is the product of the corrupting action of civilization is represented by the term

   A) hedonism.
   B) humanism.
   C) meliorism.
   D) noble savage.
   E) primitivism.

7. Drama that presents a view of the ridiculousness and ludicrousness of the human condition through its abandonment of the usual or rational devices and by its use of nonrealistic form is known as

   A) *reductio ad absurdum*.
   B) Theater of Cruelty.
   C) Theater of the Absurd.
   D) tragedy of blood.
   E) tragicomedy.

8. The state of being on a threshold in space or time, including places in time where many social meanings congregate is called

   A) epiphany.
   B) foregrounding.
   C) liminality.
   D) luminism.
   E) perspectivism.

9. **Not**, by definition, a genre that addresses the development of a young person is the

   A) *Bildungsroman*.
   B) *Entwicklungsroman*.
   C) *Erziehungsroman*.
   D) *Künstlerroman*.
   E) *roman à clef*.

10. The prolific novelist, essayist, screenwriter, and recipient of the 1986 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for *Lonesome Dove* is

    A) Cormac McCarthy.
    B) Larry McMurtry.
    C) Philip Roth.
    D) Peter Taylor.
    E) John Updike.

11. A word or name fabricated by spelling another word or words backward, as when Daniel Suarez, in 2006, published his novel *Daemon* under the authorship of Leinad Zeraus, is called a(n)

A) allonym.
B) ananym.
C) eponym.
D) heteronym.
E) pseudonym.

12. The author of the Middle English masterpieces *The Book of the Duchess*, *Troilus and Criseyde*, and *The House of Fame* is

A) Geoffrey Chaucer.
B) William Langland.
C) Thomas Mallory.
D) Thomas More.
E) William of Ockham.

13. The literary period during which appeared on the English stage Dryden's *All for Love*, Wycherley's *The Country Wife*, Etherege's *The Man of Mode*, Behn's *Oroonoko*, and Congreve's *Love for Love* and *The Way of the World* is called the

A) Early Tudor Age.
B) Early Victorian Age.
C) Edwardian Age.
D) Elizabethan Age.
E) Restoration Age.

14. Closely related to both Aristotle's "catharsis" and Longinus's "transport," the judging of a work of art in terms of its results, especially its emotional effect, is

A) aesthetic distance.
B) affective fallacy.
C) intentional fallacy.
D) logical positivism.
E) pathetic fallacy.

15. The international tendency in the graphic and literary arts, especially painting and prose fiction, in which the frame or surface of the work may be conventional, but contrasting elements—such as the supernatural, myth, dream, fantasy—invade and change the whole basis of the art is known as

A) magic realism.
B) modernism.
C) orphism.
D) sentimentalism.
E) surrealism.

16. The impressionist dramatist and novelist whose work is recognized as deeply influential on the Theater of the Absurd and who received the 1934 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) Giosuè Carducci.
B) Grazia Deledda.
C) Eugenio Montale.
D) Luigi Pirandello.
E) Salvatore Quasimodo.

17. **Not** among postmodern writers who have experimented with form and aesthetic surfaces, as well as with themes of alienation and asocialism, is

A) Chinua Achebe.
B) Donald Barthelme.
C) John Fowles.
D) Thomas Pynchon.
E) Alain Robbe-Grillet.

18. Literature, usually prose fiction, entirely or partly written as letters, such as Samuel Richardson's *Pamela*, Henry Fielding's *Shamela*, Johann Wolfgang von Goethe's *The Sorrows of Young Werther*, and Alice Walker's *The Color Purple* is called

A) epistolary novel.
B) framework-story.
C) metafiction.
D) palimpsest.
E) picaresque novel.

19. An interlude in which the actors freeze in position and then resume action as before or hold their position until the curtain drops is a(n)

A) meditation.
B) montage.
C) mosaic.
D) tableau.
E) uncial.

20. In an old theory of physiology, the four chief liquids of the human body associated with the four elements, or an individual's personal characteristics, physical, mental, and moral, that are explained by his or her temperament or the balance of the liquids in the body, are the

A) archetypes.
B) duodecimos.
C) humours.
D) quartos.
E) sigla.

21. **Not** among the Pulitzer Prizes for Drama awarded to musicals is

A) Kirkwood and Dante's 1976 *A Chorus Line*.
B) Larson's 1996 *Rent*.
C) Miller's 1949 *Death of a Salesman*.
D) Rodgers, Hammerstein, and Logan's 1950 *South Pacific*.
E) Weidman, Abbott, Bock, and Harnick's 1960 *Fiorello!*

22. The period in American literary history following the Civil War for which fiction became the effective voice of the new turbulence, the growing skepticism and disillusionment, and culminating with the publication of Dreiser's *Sister Carrie* is the

A) Naturalistic and Symbolistic Period.
B) Period of Conformity.
C) Period of the Confessional Self.
D) Realistic Period. 399
E) Romantic Period.

23. The system for describing conventional rhythms by dividing lines into feet, indicating the locations of binomial accents, and counting the syllables is known as

A) exegesis.
B) reception theory.
C) scansion.
D) typology.
E) versification.

24. The belief that nature (in the sense of what exists undisturbed by human artifice) is preferable and fundamentally better than any aspect of human culture is

A) classicism.
B) cultural primitivism.
C) medievalism.
D) meliorism.
E) vorticism.

25. The type of criticism dedicated both to defining the types or categories into which literary works and cinematic films are grouped according to, among other things, form and subject matter, and to tracing the works' (or films') histories and interactions is

A) formalism.
B) genre criticism.
C) postcolonial criticism.
D) reader-response criticism.
E) structuralism.

26. The trope in which a part signifies the whole or the whole signifies the part is

A) conceit.
B) litotes.
C) metaphor.
D) metonymy.
E) synecdoche.

27. Classically, the employment of some unexpected and improbable incident to make things turn out right, and currently, any device whereby an author solves a difficult situation by a forced invention is called

A) *coup de théâtre*.
B) *deus ex machina*.
C) *dolce stil nuovo*.
D) *in medias res*.
E) *scène affàire*.

28. The instructiveness defining a literary work, one purpose of which is to give guidance particularly in moral, ethical, or religious matters is known as (a)

A) didacticism.
B) humanism.
C) jeremiad.
D) meliorism.
E) provincialism.

29. The twentieth-century American author of *The Heart Is a Lonely Hunter*, *The Ballad of the Sad Café*, and *The Member of the Wedding*, is

A) Willa Cather.
B) Kate Chopin.
C) Zora Neale Hurston.
D) Ursula Le Guin.
E) Carson McCullers.

30. A technique for presenting the stream of consciousness of a character that, reaching downward to the nonverbalized level where images must be used to represent sensations or emotions, presents the emotional experience is

A) aesthetic distance.
B) free indirect discourse.
C) interior monologue.
D) objective correlative.
E) suspension of disbelief.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with George Bernard Shaw's *Pygmalion*.

Items 37-42 are associated with Tim O'Brien's *The Things They Carried*.

Items 43-50 are associated with Robert Frost's poetry (selected).

31. In the opening scene of Bernard Shaw's *Pygmalion*, the Bystander explains that Higgins has been mistaken to be a "copper's nark," an informer, by (the)
    A) Eliza.
    B) Freddy.
    C) Note Taker.
    D) Pickering.
    E) Taximan.

32. Higgins, while speaking to Mrs. Pearce about the questionable potential that is Eliza Doolittle, says, "She's no use: [. . .]; I'm not going to waste another cylinder on [her lingo]," the cylinder being used in
    A) baking.
    B) bathing.
    C) braking.
    D) motoring.
    E) recording.

33. The mythical Greco-Roman originals whose story Shaw borrows are
    A) Pygmalion and Althea.
    B) Pygmalion and Calypso.
    C) Pygmalion and Daphne.
    D) Pygmalion and Galatea.
    E) Pygmalion and Helen.

34. Couched in the candor of Eliza's response to Colonel Pickering, "I am a child in your country. I have forgotten my own language, and cannot speak nothing but yours," is the notion (and in Eliza's mind, certitude) of
    A) cautious xenophobia.
    B) language acquisition.
    C) legal deportation.
    D) summary deportation.
    E) ultimate liminality.

35. Eliza's defensively righteous response "I sold flowers. I didn't sell myself. Now youve made a lady of me I'm not fit to sell anything else" is a(n)
    A) admission of failure.
    B) realization that beauty is not for sale.
    C) realization that ladies do not work in retail.
    D) reminder that Eliza has no money.
    E) voicing of Shaw's criticism of class pretentiousness.

36. Higgins and Pickering, in a display that troubles Mrs. Higgins, consider taking Eliza to the Shakespear exhibition at Earls Court in order to
    A) create a distraction among the upper classes.
    B) have Eliza audition for a Shakespearean comedy.
    C) introduce Eliza to actors who make a living talking.
    D) later enjoy Eliza's mimicry of the people she hears.
    E) see if anybody recognizes her dress as Elizabethan.

---

37. In Tim O'Brien's *The Things They Carried*, the observation "They carried all they could bear, and then some, including a silent awe for the terrible power of the things they carried" is both
    A) chiasmic and zeugmatic.
    B) hyperbolic and ironic.
    C) metaleptic and metonymic.
    D) melopoeic and mythopoeic.
    E) tautological and vatic.

38. The reason that O'Brien offers that he will go to war instead of to Canada is that he
    A) understood the call of duty.
    B) understood the cold of Canada's winters.
    C) was embarrassed not to go to war.
    D) welcomed the opportunity to be a hero.
    E) would not be able to pay Berdahl back.

39. While Sanders and Dobbins are debating the moral of a story, Sanders remembers an "old TV show," specifically, *Have Gun–Will Travel*, which constitutes a(n)
    A) allusion.
    B) connotation.
    C) denotation.
    D) double entendre.
    E) rebus.

40. O'Brien asks his father to take him to see Linda in repose because he needs "something to carry with [him] when she [is] gone"; this "something" is (a)
    A) corroboration of an afterlife.
    B) evidence that the hat was necessary.
    C) final confirmation.
    D) funeral program from the visitation.
    E) lock of hair.

41. The true war story, defined many times in O'Brien's work, is, at one point said to be "about sisters who never write back and people who never listen," which brings together the palimpsest through which runs a difficult-to-forget thread involving

A) Jimmy Cross, Kiowa, and O'Brien.
B) Jimmy Cross, Martha, and O'Brien.
C) Mark Fossie, Norman Bowker, and O'Brien.
D) Curt Lemon, Rat Kiley, and O'Brien.
E) Nick Veenhof, Linda, and O'Brien.

42. Henry Dobbins, "who moved gracefully for such a big man," takes Azar "from behind and lift[s] him up high and carr[ys] him over to a deep well and ask[s] if he want[s] to be dumped in" because Azar has

A) desecrated a Vietnamese body.
B) laughed at Fossie's losing Mary Anne.
C) mocked a young Vietnamese girl's dancing.
D) refused to help retrieve Kiowa's body.
E) shot a baby water buffalo in the knee.

Items 43-48 refer to Robert Frost's

The Road Not Taken

Two roads diverged in a yellow wood,
And sorry I could not travel both
And be one traveler, long I stood
And looked down one as far as I could
To where it bent in the undergrowth;

Then took the other, as just as fair,
And having perhaps the better claim,
Because it was grassy and wanted wear;
Though as for that the passing there
Had worn them really about the same,

And both that morning equally lay
In leaves no step had trodden black.
Oh, I kept the first for another day!
Yet knowing how way leads on to way,
I doubted if I should ever come back.

I shall be telling this with a sigh
Somewhere ages and ages hence:
Two roads diverged in a wood, and I–
I took the one less traveled by,
And that has made all the difference.

43. Both the tone and the theme of Robert Frost's "The Road Not Taken" can be recognized in the relationship between

A) line 1 and line 19.
B) line 2 and line 20.
C) line 6 and line 13.
D) line 8 and line 12.
E) the poem's title and line 16.

44. The word *wanted* in line 8 means

A) accustomed.
B) lacked.
C) needed.
D) required.
E) sought.

45. The underlying metrical pattern of the poem is

A) iambic pentameter.
B) iambic tetrameter.
C) trochaic pentameter.
D) trochaic tetrameter.
E) spondaic hexameter.

46. The bifurcation that serves as the controlling image of the poem represents, metaphorically, a(n)

A) crossroads.
B) decision.
C) elusive promise.
D) favored opportunity.
E) lost opportunity.

47. The philosophical observation "Yet knowing how way leads on to way" (line 14) means that

A) death awaits, no matter the path.
B) divergence can reconverge.
C) some paths lead deeper into the wood.
D) there is always time for a second journey.
E) we cannot know where life will take us.

48. The formula that Frost's "The Road Not Taken" embraces is

A) *carpe diem*.
B) *fin de siècle*.
C) *in medias res*.
D) *jeu d'espirit*.
E) *ubi sunt*.

Items 49-50 refer to Robert Frost's

A Prayer in Spring

Oh, give us pleasure in the flowers to-day;
And give us not to think so far away
As the uncertain harvest; keep us here
All simply in the springing of the year.

Oh, give us pleasure in the orchard white,
Like nothing else by day, like ghosts by night;
And make us happy in the happy bees,
The swarm dilating round the perfect trees.

And make us happy in the darting bird
That suddenly above the bees is heard,
The meteor that thrusts in with needle bill,
And off a blossom in mid air stands still.

For this is love and nothing else is love,
The which it is reserved for God above
To sanctify to what far ends He will,
But which it only needs that we fulfill.

49. Both auditory and visual imagery dominate Frost's poem's

A) first and second stanzas.
B) fourth stanza.
C) second and third stanzas.
D) second stanza.
E) third stanza.

50. "The meteor that thrusts in with needle bill, / and off a blossom in mid air stands still" (lines 11-12) is (a/an)

A) anhinga.
B) dilating swarm.
C) God's love.
D) hummingbird.
E) queen bee.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-55 refer to William Shakespeare's

Sonnet 65

Since brass, nor stone, nor earth, nor boundless sea,
But sad mortality o'ersways their power,
How with this rage shall beauty hold a plea,
Whose action is no stronger than a flower?
O! how shall summer's honey breath hold out,
Against the wrackful siege of battering days,
When rocks impregnable are not so stout,
Nor gates of steel so strong but Time decays?
O fearful meditation! where, alack,
Shall Time's best jewel from Time's chest lie hid?
Or what strong hand can hold his swift foot back?
Or who his spoil of beauty can forbid?
O! none, unless this miracle have might,
That in black ink my love may still shine bright.

51. The theme of Shakespeare's Sonnet 65 is (the)

A) beauty is a jewel to be kept in a chest.
B) inevitability of death.
C) sad mortality is impregnable.
D) time as a destroyer.
E) wrackfulness of a siege.

52. Line 5's "summer's honey breath" is

A) line 1's boundless sea.
B) line 2's mortality.
C) line 3's beauty.
D) line 4's action.
E) line 4's flower.

53. The miracle to which the couplet makes reference is (the)

A) fearful meditation.
B) Shakespeare's sonnet.
C) spoil of beauty.
D) summer's honey breath.
E) Time's best jewel.

54. The rhyme that characterizes lines 2 and 4 of Shakespeare's Sonnet 65 is

A) feminine rhyme.
B) identical rhyme.
C) leonine rhyme.
D) masculine rhyme.
E) slant rhyme.

55. The treatment of Time throughout the sonnet, but especially in lines 8-12, constitutes

A) anthropomorphism.
B) apostrophe.
C) mimesis.
D) pathetic fallacy.
E) personification.

Items 56-59 refer to Edwin Arlington Robinson's

The House on the Hill

They are all gone away,
The House is shut and still,
There is nothing more to say.

Through broken walls and gray
The winds blow bleak and shrill.
They are all gone away.

Nor is there one to-day
To speak them good or ill:
There is nothing more to say.

Why is it then we stray
Around the sunken sill?
They are all gone away,

And our poor fancy-play
For them is wasted skill:
There is nothing more to say.

There is ruin and decay
In the House on the Hill:
They are all gone away,
There is nothing more to say.

56. The oft-repeated lines "They are all gone away" and "There is nothing more to say" of Edwin Arlington Robinson's "The House on the Hill" are

A) euhemeristic.
B) euphemistic.
C) euphonic.
D) euphuistic.
E) nekuian.

57. The form of Robinson's "The House on the Hill" is the

A) *chant royal*.
B) pantoum.
C) rondeau.
D) *terza rima*.
E) villanelle.

58. The poem's titular subject, the house on the hill, can be recognized as being symbolic of the speaker's

A) exes.
B) disregarded friendships.
C) misguided fancy-plays.
D) past life.
E) run-down houses.

59. The tone of Robinson's "The House on the Hill" is

A) laconically morose.
B) morbidly depressed.
C) pessimistically reminiscent.
D) resignedly nostalgic.
E) wistfully meditative.

Items 60-62 refer to John Frederick Nims's

Love Poem

My clumsiest dear, whose hands shipwreck vases,
At whose quick touch all glasses chip and ring,
Whose palms are bulls in china, burs in linen,
And have no cunning with any soft thing

Except all ill-at-ease fidgeting people:
The refugee uncertain at the door
You make at home; deftly you steady
The drunk clambering on his undulant floor.

Unpredictable dear, the taxi drivers' terror,
Shrinking from far headlights pale as a dime
Yet leaping before apoplectic streetcars—
Misfit in any space. And never on time.

A wrench in clocks and the solar system. Only
With words and people and love you move at ease;
In traffic of wit expertly maneuver
And keep us, all devotion, at your knees.

Forgetting your coffee spreading on our flannel,
Your lipstick grinning on our coat,
So gaily in love's unbreakable heaven
Our souls on glory of spilt bourbon float.

Be with me, darling, early and late. Smash glasses—
I will study wry music for your sake.
For should your hands drop white and empty
All the toys of the world would break.

60. Nims's "Love Poem" begins with and continues as a(n)

A) apostrophe.
B) aside.
C) harangue.
D) invocation.
E) pleonasm.

61. The stanza or stanzas that irrevocably affirm the speaker's intent in entitling his poem "Love Poem" are the

A) fifth and sixth.
B) first.
C) second and third.
D) sixth.
E) third and fourth.

62. In line 13 of Nims's poem, the joining of the objects "clocks" and "solar systems," two objects not exactly on the same level, is an example of the figure of speech known as (a)

A) heaping figure.
B) hendiadys.
C) hyperbole.
D) paradox.
E) tautology.

Items 63-65 refer to Garrison Keillor's

The Anthem
[If Robert Frost had written "The Star-Spangled Banner"]

Whose flag is this I think I know
His house is being bombed now though
He will not see that I have come
To watch the twilight's ebbing glow.

My little horse must think it dumb,
The cannons' pandemonium,
The rockets bursting in the air,
The sound of bugle, fife, and drum.

He turns and shakes his derrière
To show me that he doesn't care
Who takes this battle flag or why,
When in the redness of the glare

I see the banner flying high
Through the tumult of the sky
And knowing all is now okay,
We walk away, my horse and I.

The flag is lovely, hip hooray,
But I have things to do today,
Some here and others far away,
Before I drop to hit the hay.

63. The species of multiple rhyme that occurs in the pairing of lines 6 and 8, lines in which "pandemonium" rhymes with "bugle, fife, and drum," is called

A) broken rhyme.
B) compound rhyme.
C) heteromerous rhyme.
D) macaronic rhyme.
E) wrenched rhyme.

64. The inversion of the normal sentence order, as found in the first line of Keillor's poem, is

A) baring the device.
B) gallows humor.
C) heteroglossia.
D) hyperbaton.
E) transumption.

65. Keillor's poem is, at its core, a

A) burlesque.
B) farce.
C) hoax.
D) melodrama.
E) parody.

Required tie-breaking essay prompt on the next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Ruth Fainlight's "Crocuses," and discuss the tonal shift associated with the poem's range of imagery.

Crocuses *

Pale, bare, tender stems rising
from the muddy winter-faded grass,

shivering petals the almost luminous
blue and mauve of bruises on the naked

bodies of men, women, children
herded into a forest clearing or

before the shouted order, crack of gunfire,
final screams and prayers and moans.

* crocuses are early-blooming spring flowers symbolic of mirthfulness and resurrection

KEY

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line arrows up ➔

both #34 and #35 are E

1.	C	309
2.	A	72
3.	D	353
4.	E	550
5.	B	604
6.	D	324
7.	C	2
8.	C	273
9.	E	418
10.	B	603
11.	B	24
12.	A	522
13.	E	408
14.	B	7
15.	A	284
16.	D	599
17.	A	375
18.	A	179
19.	D	472
20.	C	240
21.	C	607
22.	D	399
23.	C	430
24.	B	125
25.	B	215
26.	E	470
27.	B	137
28.	A	142
29.	E	58
30.	C	254
31.	A	17
32.	E	32
33.	D	
34.	E	96
35.	E	100
36.	D	85
37.	A	
38.	C	57
39.	A	14
40.	C	228
41.	D	81
42.	C	130
43.	E	
44.	B	
45.	B	
46.	B	
47.	E	
48.	A	75
49.	C	
50.	D	
51.	D	
52.	C	
53.	B	
54.	A	196
55.	E	361
56.	B	186
57.	E	497
58.	D	
59.	D	
60.	A	37
61.	A	
62.	B	229
63.	C	232
64.	D	242
65.	E	353

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e, the Simon & Schuster *Pygmalion*, the Mariner-Houghton *The Things They Carried*, and to Untermeyer's Frost collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Ruth Fainlight's "Crocuses"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used in a discussion of the tonal shift in Ruth Fainlight's "Crocuses" include

auditory imagery,
cognitive dissonance,
diction,
dissonance,
enjambment,
irony,
melopoeia,
onomatopoeia,
polysyndeton,
rhythm,
sigmatism,
stanza,
synæsthesia,
syntax,
tactile imagery,
tone, and
visual imagery.

The contestant should comment on the disconnect between the title and the overall effect of Fainlight's "Crocuses." The title, in retrospect, heralds the tonal shift that occurs across the enjambment that unites stanzas three and four. The momentary—and untroubling—anticipatory shiftings in visual imagery that are anchored in the diction sequences "pale, bare, tender" and muddy winter-faded" are followed by the subtle synæsthesia of "shivering petals" (shivering moving from the visual imagery dominating the first half of the poem to the auditory of the second half), the poem's shifting to imagery that is, in its finality, a painfully auditory underscoring the tonal shift.

The natural beauty of a scene that elicits a sense of tranquility, if not a sense of innocence-not-quite Edenic, shifts, as people are herded toward a dissonance that overwhelms in the suddenness of the onomatopoeic immediacy of *crack* and the onomatopoeic finality of the paced (*via* polysyndeton) *screams* and *prayers* and *moans*.

The writer, sensitive to the possibilities of "how way leads on to way" (Frost, "Road Not Taken"), might draw a parallel that begins with the naturalness of the cycle of life and death (the crocuses and the fading grass) and ends with the violent intrusion that is humanity's propensity to ensure that life finds an unnaturally tragic end.

ANSWER SHEET

UIL Literary Criticism
District 1 • 2016

Items 1-30 **1** *point each*

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Items 31-65 **2** *points each*

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Part 3

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contestant number

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SCORE

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

FIRST GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

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initials

SECOND GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

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THIRD GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

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